

MPC-PiNNs technique applied to Quadrotors

Elective in Robotics [UAV] Course Project

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Neural Model Predictive Control (NMPC)

1 Introduction

In this work we have tried to combine Model Predictive Control along with PiNNs to trajectory tracking problem applied to quadrotors. We have used the Unicycle robot as simple test case for our experiments.



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Quadorotor

2 Robot Models

Since we have used the Crazyflie robot as reference, instead of using the classic second order simplified model we have used a first order one.

$$\begin{cases} \ddot{x} = -(\cos \psi \sin \theta \cos \phi + \sin \psi \sin \phi) \frac{T}{m} \\ \ddot{y} = -(\sin \psi \sin \theta \cos \phi - \cos \psi \sin \phi) \frac{T}{m} \\ \ddot{z} = -(\cos \theta \cos \phi) \frac{T}{m} + g \\ \ddot{\phi} = \frac{\tau_{\phi}}{I_x} \\ \ddot{\theta} = \frac{\tau_{\theta}}{I_y} \\ \ddot{\psi} = \frac{\tau_{\psi}}{I_z} \end{cases} \quad (1)$$



Unicycle

2 Robot Models

Instead of using the dynamic model of the robot, we have modeled it with its kinematic model, which will be the one approximated by the network.

$$\begin{cases} \dot{x} = v \cos(\theta) \\ \dot{y} = v \sin(\theta) \\ \dot{\theta} = w \end{cases} \quad (2)$$



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Model Predictive Control

3 Model Predictive Control

Our objective is to minimize at each step the error with respect to the reference trajectory, while also maintaining the module of the input actions as low as possible

$$\min_{u(0), u(1), \dots, u(N-1)} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \ell(x(k), u(k)) + \ell_f(x(N)) \quad (3)$$

$$\text{s.t. } x(k+1) = f(x(k), u(k)), \quad k = 0, \dots, N-1, \quad (4)$$

$$x(k) \in \mathcal{X}, \quad u(k) \in \mathcal{U}, \quad k = 0, \dots, N-1, \quad (5)$$

$$x(0) = x_0 \quad (6)$$

This approach leads to good result for both the drone and unicycle models.



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Simple MLP

4 Neural Network

We have started by using a simple Neural Network to approximate the kinematic model of the Unicycle. The architecture is characterized by two hidden layers of 128 neurons and takes as input the current state and the action that I want to apply.

$$loss = \frac{1}{k} \sum_{i=t}^{t+k} (\bar{s}_i - s_i)^2 \quad (7)$$

The loss is computed as the MSE between the neural and the nominal evolutions of the state.



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PiNNs

5 Physical Informed Neural Networks

Physical Informed Neural Networks (PiNNs) propose an alternative approach where the solution is approximated by a neural network that is trained not only on data but also by enforcing the underlying physical laws via the differential equations.

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{data}}(\theta) = \frac{1}{N_u} \sum_{i=1}^{N_u} |u_{\theta}(\mathbf{x}_i, t_i) - u_i^{\text{obs}}|^2 \quad (8)$$

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{phys}}(\theta) = \frac{1}{N_r} \sum_{j=1}^{N_r} |\mathcal{N}[u_{\theta}](\mathbf{x}_j, t_j)|^2, \quad (9)$$



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Dataset Generation

6 Results and Problems Encountered



Integration technique used

6 Results and Problems Encountered



Why we have chosen to use PiNNs with Control instead of classic PiNNs

6 Results and Problems Encountered



Drift Problem

6 Results and Problems Encountered

After some training, we have tested our neural model along with the MPC with nice results (check video). However, we found out that by having zero control inputs the networks still moves the state somewhere else. We have tried to overcome this problem in some ways but with poor results:

- Sample N sample points at the boundary during each epoch
- Add a penalty term related to the boundary condition



Possible Local Minima

6 Results and Problems Encountered

During each training experiment, we have found out that all losses behave correctly but they remain stuck at some points even with few iterations. Also in this case we have tried extensively hyperparameter tuning without any solution to the problem.



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